

Courtship

At various stages in her life, a female bird will be on the lookout for a mate. Males go out of their way to impress the ladies, often in spectacular ways.



A good decorator

The male satin bowerbird builds an avenue of twigs, and at each end he places a collection of anything he finds attractive, such as shells, bones, or berries. The female picks the bower she finds the most appealing.

weird but true

Some birds of prey perform amazing aerobatic displays. The male and female lock talons in mid-air and fall almost to the ground before swooping up again.

Fierce competition

There is often competition between the males to attract the females, so performances have to be very slick. This female has chosen her mate.

Crowned cranes

